

BOK CHOY

Brassica rapa var. *chinensis*

Bok choy—or pak choi, as it is sometimes called—is a quick-growing member of the Oriental brassica family. Like Chinese cabbage, it is delicious in salads and is a useful late summer crop, but has larger, darker leaves and a more delicate taste. The leaves, stems, and flowering shoots of bok choy are all edible; harvest leaves when young for use in salads, or leave to mature for cooking lightly in stir-fries.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Bok choy prefers a sheltered, sunny site with fertile, moisture-retentive soil. Dig in some well-rotted manure or compost in the fall before sowing the following year. Like spinach, bok choy benefits from a top-dressing of fertilizer shortly before sowing.

Sow seed directly into the ground in late spring or summer; avoid planting earlier than this, as bok choy will bolt if conditions are too cold. You can sow earlier in spring under cover in a heated greenhouse and transplant. Sow seed at a depth of .75 in (2 cm).

Plants will need about 12 in (30 cm) of spacing if they are to be harvested whole, but only 4 in (10 cm) if you plan to harvest just the leaves. Consider



Leave the cut stems to resproul.

intercropping among other, slower-growing crops such as sweet corn, since bok choy grows relatively quickly.

CROP CARE

Because of its shallow roots, bok choy needs to be watered regularly to ensure it doesn't dry out. Bok choy is relatively easy to grow, but does have a tendency to bolt. Keep plants well-weeded.